

Project Management(PM)

Questions & Answers

1. What is project success?

- Has created the planned product with planned quality (**Scope**).
- Has finished within the planned schedule (**Time**).
- Has finished within the planned budget (**Cost**).

2. According to the Standish Group report (2019), what are the major factors contributing to IT project failure?

- Incomplete Requirements
- Lack of user involvement
- Lack of resources
- Unrealistic expectations
- Lack of executive support
- Changing Requirements & Specifications
- Lack of planning
- Didn't need it any longer
- Lack of IT management

3. What is a Project Manager, and what are the three requirements for a Project Manager? Explain each requirement.

- The person assigned by the performing organization to achieve the project objectives.

Three-Requirements for Project Manager:

- ❖ **Knowledge** : What the project manager knows about project management
- ❖ **Performance**: What the project manager is able to do or accomplish while applying their project management knowledge?
- ❖ **Personnel**: How the project manager behaves when performing the project or related activity.

4. What are McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y? Explain the main differences between theory X and theory Y.

Theory X

- People dislikes work and avoids it he/she can.
- Therefore most people must be forced with the threat of punishment to work towards organizational objectives.

Theory Y

- Effort in work is as natural as work and play.
- People applies self-control and self-direction in the pursuit of organizational objectives, w/o external control or punishment.

5. What is a Portfolio in project management, and are the projects or programs within a portfolio necessarily interdependent or directly related? Explain.

- A collection of projects or programs and other work that are grouped together to facilitate effective management of that work to meet strategic business objectives.
- The projects or programs of the portfolio may not necessarily be interdependent or directly related.

6. What is Portfolio Management?

- The centralized management of one or more portfolios, which includes identifying, prioritizing, authorizing, managing, and controlling projects, programs, and other related work, to achieve specific strategic objectives
- It focuses on ensuring that projects and programs are reviewed to prioritize resource allocation, and that the management of the portfolio is consistent with and aligned to organizational strategies

7. What is Program?

- A group of related projects managed in a coordinated way to obtain benefits and control not available from managing them individually.
- Programs may include elements of related work outside the scope of the discrete projects in the program.
- A project may or may not be part of a program but a program will always have projects.

8. What is Program Management?

- The centralized coordinated management of a program to achieve the program's strategic objectives and benefits.
- Projects within a program are **related through** the common outcome or collective capability.
- If the relationship between projects is only that of a shared client, seller, technology, or resource, the **effort should be managed** as a portfolio of projects rather than as a program.

9. What are the Knowledge Areas (KAs) in project management? What are any five Project Management Knowledge Areas? Explain each of them briefly.

- ❖ **Project Integration Management** - Includes the processes to identify, acquire, and manage the resources needed for the successful completion of the project
- ❖ **Project Scope Management** - Includes the processes required to ensure the project includes all the work required, and only the work required, to complete the project successfully.
- ❖ **Project Schedule Management** - Includes the processes required to manage the timely completion of the project.
- ❖ **Project Cost Management** - Includes the processes involved in planning, estimating, budgeting, financing, funding, managing, and controlling costs so the project can be completed within the approved budget.
- ❖ **Project Quality Management** - Includes the processes for incorporating the organization's quality policy regarding planning, managing, and controlling project and product quality requirements, in order to meet stakeholders' expectations.
- ❖ **Project Resource Management** - Includes the processes and activities to identify, define, combine, unify, and coordinate the various processes and project management activities within the Project Management Process Groups

- ❖ **Project Communications Management** - Includes the processes required to ensure timely and appropriate planning, collection, creation, distribution, storage, retrieval, management, control, monitoring, and ultimate disposition of project information.
- ❖ **Project Risk Management** - Includes the processes of conducting risk management planning, identification, analysis, response planning, response implementation, and monitoring risk on a project.
- ❖ **Project Procurement Management** - Includes the processes necessary to purchase or acquire products, services, or results needed from outside the project team
- ❖ **Project Stakeholder Management** - Includes the processes required to identify the people, groups, or organizations that could impact or be impacted by the project, to analyze stakeholder expectations and their impact on the project, and to develop appropriate management strategies for effectively engaging stakeholders in project decisions and execution

10. What are Enterprise Environmental Factors (EEFs) in project management?

They refer to conditions, not under the control of the project team, that influence, constrain, or direct the project

- These conditions can be internal and/or external to the organization
- They considered as inputs to many project management processes, specifically for most planning processes
- These factors may enhance or constrain project management options.
- These factors may have a positive or negative influence on the outcome.
- EEFs vary widely in type or nature. These factors need to be considered if the project is to be effective.

11. What are Internal Enterprise Environmental Factors (EEFs)?

Organizational culture, structure, and governance

- Geographic distribution of facilities and resources
- Infrastructure
- Information technology software
- Resource availability
- Employee capability

12. What are the EXTERNAL EEFs?

- Marketplace conditions
- Social and cultural influences and issues
- Legal restrictions
- Commercial databases
- Academic research
- Government or industry standards
- Financial considerations
- Physical environmental elements

13. What are Organizational Process Assets (OPAs) in project management?

The plans, processes, policies, procedures, and knowledge bases specific to and used by the performing organization

- These assets influence the management of the project
- Any artifact, practice, or knowledge from any or all of the performing organizations involved in the project
- Organization's lessons learned from previous projects and historical information and completed schedules, risk data, and earned value data

- Inputs to many project management processes
- The project team members may be able to update and add to the organizational process assets as necessary throughout the project.

14. What are the types of Organizational Knowledge Repositories?

- Configuration management knowledge repositories containing the versions of software and hardware components and baselines of all performing organization standards, policies, procedures, and any project documents;
- Financial data repositories containing information such as labor hours, incurred costs, budgets, and any project cost overruns;
- Historical information and lessons learned knowledge repositories
- Issue and defect management data repositories containing issue and defect status, control information, issue and defect resolution, and action item results;
- Data repositories for metrics used to collect and make available measurement data on **processes and products**; and Project files from previous projects

15. What is GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK?

- Governance is the framework within which authority is exercised in organizations.
- Rules, policies, procedures, norms, relationships, systems, and processes.
- This framework influences how:
 - ❖ Objectives of the organization are set and achieved,
 - ❖ Risk is monitored and assessed, and
 - ❖ Performance is optimized
- Develop Project Charter: Tools and Techniques (data gathering)

16. What is Brainstorming in project management?

To identify a list of ideas in a short period of time

- Conducted in a group environment and is led by a facilitator
- Comprises two parts: idea generation and analysis
- Can be used to gather data and solutions or ideas from stakeholders, subject matter experts, and team members when developing the project charter

17. What is Conflict management in project management?

- Used to help bring stakeholders into alignment on the objectives, success criteria, high-level requirements, project description, summary milestones, and other elements of the charter.

18. What is Meeting management?

- meetings are held with key stakeholders to identify the project objectives, success criteria, key deliverables, high-level requirements, summary milestones, and other summary information
- Includes preparing the agenda, ensuring that a representative for each key stakeholder group is invited, and preparing and sending the follow-up minutes and actions.

19. What are the elements of a Project Charter?

Project purpose;

- Measurable project objectives and related success criteria;
- High-level requirements;

- High-level project description, boundaries, and key deliverables;
- Overall project risk;
- Summary milestone schedule;
- Preapproved financial resources;
- Key stakeholder list;
- Project approval requirements (i.e., what constitutes project success, who decides the project is successful, and who signs off on the project);
- Project exit criteria (i.e., what are the conditions to be met in order to close or to cancel the project or phase);
- Assigned project manager, responsibility, and authority level; and
- Name and authority of the sponsor or other person(s) authorizing the project charter

20. What are the elements of a Project Scope Statement?

❖ Project Overview

- Brief description of the project and the product of the project.

❖ Project Background and Goals

- The reason why the project should be implemented and the goal that the project should achieve.
- This part is important for project evaluation at the closing phase

❖ List of Project Deliverables

- Deliverables” mean any tangible output from the project.
- For example, in software development project, they will be software source code and compiled program, operation manuals, testing result, and so on.

❖ Time and Cost Estimates

- This will be rough estimates of the time frame and cost, but should at least have some “numbers”, such as “The cost will be less than 15,000 dollar”.

21. What are Constraints in a Project Scope Statement?

- Constraints are factors and obstacles that limit or prevent the extent of the project.
- These include budgetary limitation, resource limitation, time limitation

22. What is Reserved Time (Contingency/Buffer) in project management? Explain its purpose.

- An additional time frame, called time reserve, contingency, or buffer, that can be added to the activity duration or elsewhere in the schedule in order to prepare for any schedule risk
- A percentage of the estimated duration, or a fixed number of work periods

23. Explain Analogous Estimating.

- a form of expert judgment
- only reliable when (a) the previous activities are similar both in nature and its content, and (b) the individuals preparing the estimates have enough experiences

24. What is Parametric Estimating?

- An algorithm is used to calculate cost or duration based on historical data and project parameters.

- Calculated by multiplying the quantities to be performed for each specific work category (lines of code, number of test cases, etc.) with the productivity unit rate.

25. What is Quality Management Plan?

- The process of identifying quality requirements and/or standards for the project and its deliverables and documenting how the project will demonstrate compliance with quality requirements and/or standards